Where our products sit

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6 · 14.8s	"LLM Decides the Next Step" · "No Step to Decide" · "Agent Decides Everything"	Before we jump into RiskMind, let's start with the AI products we all use every day. How are they different, and when should you use which one? To answer that, I've put them all on one map, with one axis: how much the LLM gets to decide the next step. That's because to actually do a task, an AI needs a brain to figure out what to do, and hands, meaning tools, to go and do it. Every AI product has both. What really sets them apart is how much the brain gets to decide on its own. On the far left, there's only one step, so there's no step to decide. On the far right, the agent decides everything on its own, with no human involved at all. With this map, I'll walk you through some common concepts in the AI world, and place the products built inside RBC on it, so we can compare them clearly. There are a lot of new terms out there, and every AI company seems to invent its own. So to keep things consistent, I'll use Anthropic's definitions. They make the model RiskMind runs on.
7 · 17.9s	"CHAT" · "Single Step" · "Augmented LLM" · "RBC Assist Pro" · "MCP" · "In" · "LLM" · "Out" · "An LLM enhanced with retrieval, tools and memory"	On the far left is RBC Assist Pro. Most of you already use it. It's the chatbot everyone at RBC knows, so we'll use it as our benchmark for RiskMind. Behind the scenes, in Anthropic's terms, RBC Assist Pro is an augmented LLM. That's an LLM enhanced with retrieval, tools and memory. It's the brain and the hands we just talked about. The LLM is the brain, and the tools are the hands. MCP, up here, is a standard way to plug those tools in. And

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		that's the simplest structure of an AI product. But no matter how many tools it has, the LLM only thinks once. It takes your prompt, thinks, and answers. It doesn't take an action, look at the result, and then think again about what to do next. So there's only one step, and nothing for the LLM to decide. That's why this part of the map is called Chat. And for simple, straightforward tasks, that's all you need.
8 · 23.5s	"AGENTIC SYSTEMS" · "Multiple Steps, Long-Running Tasks" · "Prompt Chaining" · "LLM" · "Each LLM call processes the output of the previous one"	But what if the task is more complicated? Say you want to run an analysis. You need to pull data from a database, slice and dice it, and then come up with an answer. And you want that done automatically, without guiding the chatbot step by step. One augmented LLM isn't enough for that. So we use the augmented LLM as a building block, and connect several of them together. Anthropic calls this an agentic system. It handles multiple steps and long-running tasks. The way the blocks are connected is called an agentic pattern. So agentic system is the broad category, and within it, different patterns give the LLM different amounts of say over the next step. The simplest pattern is prompt chaining. Each LLM call processes the output of the previous one, in a fixed line. For our analysis, step one pulls the data, step two slices and dices it, and step three writes the answer. The order is set in advance, so the LLM has no say in what comes next.
9 · 29.1s	"Autonomous Agent" · "LLM" · "Env" · "Agent without Human In the Loop"	At the other extreme is the autonomous agent. You give it a goal, and from there, the agent decides every step on its own and keeps going until the job is done. There's no human in the loop.

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		Nobody checks its work along the way, and nobody signs off on what it produces. It's 100% automatic. That's a theoretical boundary. Right now, we don't have any product at RBC that's designed this way.
10 · 35.9s	"Prompt Chaining" · "Autonomous Agent"	These two are agentic patterns, not real products. So we'll keep them as the two ends of the scale for agentic systems. Most of our products sit somewhere in between.
11 · 37.9s	"Workflow" · "DocuMind" · "LLM" · "LLMs and tools orchestrated through predefined code paths"	As I mentioned earlier, we have two vertical applications in Risk Management, DocuMind and RiskMind. Both of them are agentic systems. By Anthropic's definition, DocuMind is a workflow. Its LLMs and tools are connected through paths that are written in code ahead of time. The LLM can act as a router, picking which path to take. But once it's on a path, it just runs to the end. It never looks back at the results to decide what to do next. There's no loop. Prompt chaining, which we just saw, is the simplest workflow, just one straight line. DocuMind has more paths to choose from, so it's a fairly sophisticated workflow. But it's still a workflow.
12 · 42.3s	"Agent" · "RiskMind" · "Skills" · "LLM" · "Env" · "LLM decides each step, guided by natural language"	RiskMind is different, because it adds a loop. Env here means the environment, the data and systems RiskMind works with. The result of its interaction with the environment goes back to the LLM as context for deciding what to do next, until the LLM thinks the task is done. That loop is the key difference between an agent and a workflow. By design, that makes RiskMind more flexible than DocuMind. But it's still a fairly constrained agent. For now, its

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		steps are predefined too. They're just written in natural language instead of code, in what we call Skills. We'll come back to Skills later. For now, think of a Skill as a package of knowledge we give the agent. The LLM reads that guidance and works out the next step. And unlike the autonomous agent, there's a human in the loop. The Risk Manager approves, reviews and validates what RiskMind produces.
13 · 50.0s	"Different Use Cases, Different Patterns" · "Stability" · "Creativity"	Now, you might think that the further right a product sits, the more advanced it is, because the LLM gets to do more. That's not really true. Every pattern has its pros and cons. Toward the left, you get stability. The steps are fixed, so the only thing that varies is the LLM's own answer, which can come out slightly different each time. Toward the right, you get flexibility and creativity. The product can handle more situations and solve more open-ended problems. But it's less predictable, so it needs more testing and evaluation. So this isn't a ranking. Different use cases call for different patterns.
14 · 53.1s	"General-purpose, end-user driven, broad but shallow. Summarize commentaries and aggregate top of the house." · "Purpose-built for risk insight workflows, SME expertise embedded, deep in the domain." · "Enterprise-wide" · "Expertise in workflow" · "Expertise in Skills" · "Vertical" · "Domain expertise" · "Horizontal" · "For all RBC employees"	Now let's compare RBC Assist Pro with RiskMind. As we mentioned earlier, RBC Assist Pro is a horizontal application. It's built for all RBC employees and has no domain expertise of its own. So it's general-purpose and driven by the user, broad but shallow. RiskMind is a vertical application. It's purpose-built for risk insight, with domain expertise in its Skills, so it goes deep.
15 · 55.1s	"RiskMind is the complement to RBC Assist Pro, not a competitor."	So when it comes to positioning, RiskMind is the complement to RBC Assist Pro, not a competitor. RBC Assist Pro gives every employee broad

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		productivity. RiskMind goes deep into risk management.